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05 Laboratory Exercise 2	Info Assurance Security

Reflection on Security Awareness Training

After reading several articles about security awareness training, I gained a deeper understanding of how important it is for organizations to educate their employees about cyber threats. The first article I read from Kaspersky explained that security awareness training is a program designed to teach employees how to recognize and avoid cyber risks, such as phishing emails, weak passwords, and social engineering attacks. The article pointed out that human error is responsible for a large portion of security incidents, which highlights the need for proper training. Kaspersky emphasized that effective training should include interactive modules, regular refreshers, and guidance on maintaining good password hygiene.

The second article from Mimecast offered a slightly different perspective. It emphasized that employees should not only be aware of security risks but also develop the skills to handle them properly. Mimecast distinguished between “awareness,” which is about cultivating the right mindset, and “training,” which focuses on practical skills. The article recommended frequent, short lessons instead of one long session, and suggested using simulations of real attacks to reinforce learning. I found this idea very practical because it shows that learning is more effective when it is interactive and repeated over time. Positive reinforcement, rather than fear-based approaches, was also recommended as a way to encourage better security behavior.

The third article from CSO Online provided practical advice on implementing security awareness programs. It explained why training is necessary, the topics that should be covered, and how organizations can measure the effectiveness of their programs. The article mentioned that well-designed training can reduce the risk of phishing attacks by about fifty percent and provide a strong return on investment by preventing costly security incidents. I was particularly interested in the discussion about measuring outcomes, as it shows that training is not only about awareness but also about creating measurable improvements in organizational security.

Reflecting on these articles, I realized that people are often the weakest link in cybersecurity. No matter how strong an organization’s technical defenses are, employees can unintentionally cause security breaches if they do not know how to respond to threats. This makes training essential, not just as a requirement for compliance, but as a way to protect the organization from real risks. I also learned that security awareness alone is not enough. Employees need practical skills to act safely in real situations. For example, knowing what a phishing email looks like is useful, but knowing how to report it or avoid clicking on a malicious link is even more important.

Another insight I gained is that training must be continuous and engaging. Short, interactive lessons delivered regularly are more effective than a single annual session. Simulations and role-

based scenarios help employees apply what they have learned and make the training more relevant to their specific roles. I also understood the importance of building a security culture where everyone in the organization feels responsible for safety. Security should not be seen as only the IT department's concern. Positive reinforcement, recognition for good practices, and encouraging employees to report suspicious activity all contribute to creating this culture.

Personally, I have noticed that many workplaces do not take security awareness seriously. Trainings are often boring or infrequent, which limits their effectiveness. From my perspective, whether in educational systems, eLearning platforms, or small businesses, it is essential that employees and users are educated about online safety. Training should be practical, easy to understand, and relevant to everyday situations. A strong security culture benefits everyone because it reduces risk and builds trust between employees, the organization, and its customers.

In conclusion, reading these articles helped me understand that security awareness training is a vital part of organizational security. It is not just about teaching rules or compliance, but about changing behavior and creating a culture where everyone takes part in protecting the organization. Effective training combines awareness and practical skills, is delivered continuously, and is tailored to the roles of the employees. Organizations that invest in strong security awareness programs can significantly reduce risk, prevent costly incidents, and ensure that their employees are confident and capable of facing cyber threats.